

6 Contributing with SourceJuicer

Contributing to an open source project can be a very rewarding experience. If you decide to contribute code to a open source project, you can do it in many ways. For example, you can contribute by developing new application, add features to an existing application or port an application to a platform so that people can install and use it. In this chapter, we will learn how to port applications on OpenSolaris, so that you can port your own applications on it, or port existing open source applications so that many other people can use it by downloading and installing it through the OpenSolaris IPS repositories. There are thousands of applications which are out there for you to port, and it will be an easy and constructive first step if you want to become an open source contributor. In this chapter we will follow the SourceJuicer How-To guide to learn how to port your own packages in OpenSolaris.

You can download the PDF version of this How-To guide for free from <http://tr.im/sjhowto>. SourceJuicer is an automatic build and package service for OpenSolaris. In particular, it allows OpenSolaris developers to submit a build recipe to the SourceJuicer build service which will be automatically compiled and an IPS package created and published to a pending repository. Once the IPS package has been published, peer developers called 'Approvers' can review the package's contents, test it out and approve it to be published into an IPS repository for other users to install. The build recipe that a developer submits takes the form of a 'spec file'. Some developers may be familiar with spec files from the RPM package management system. The spec files used for OpenSolaris are similar, but have a few differences to help provide package meta-data during the creation process. To visit SourceJuicer, browse to <http://juicer.opensolaris.org/>.

6.1 IPS repositories

IPS repositories store a collection of software packages that can be installed through the Package Manager utility on OpenSolaris. Each software package has a name, a description, a license, contents, and a list of prerequisite software packages which are necessary for this package to install and run correctly. This How To guide will explore two different IPS repositories, `/pending` and `/contrib`, and their involvement in the SourceJuicer software package life-cycle.